Bar Charts & Pictograms

Exam code: 0607

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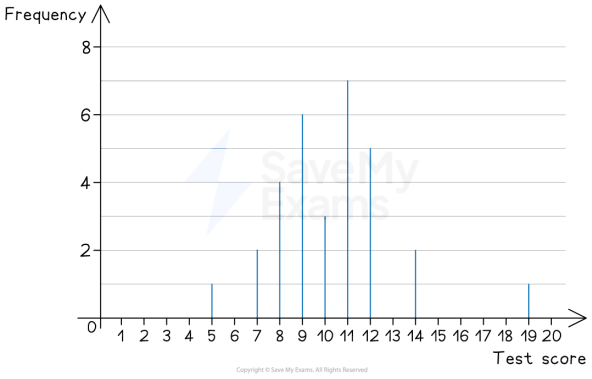
Bar charts & pictograms

What is a bar chart?

- A **bar chart** is a visual way to represent **discrete** data
  - Discrete data is data that can be **counted**
    - This can be **numerical** like shoe sizes in a class
    - Or **non-numerical** (categorical) like colours of cars down a road
- The **horizontal axis** shows the different **outcomes**
- The **vertical axis** shows the **frequency**
- The **heights** of the **bars** show the frequency
  - Bars should be **separated** by gaps
  - Bars should have **equal widths**



Example of a line chart

- The **mode** is the **outcome** with the **highest** bar

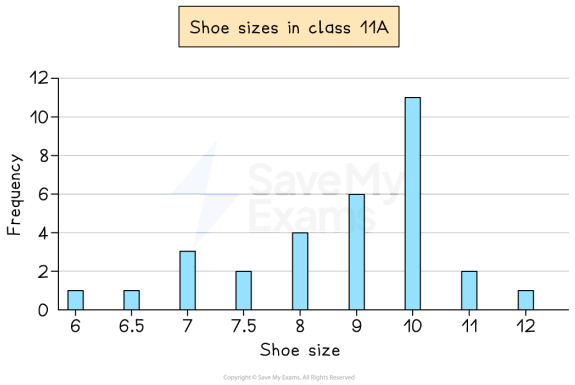
Help me understand

Examiner Tips and Tricks

If you need to find the **median** for data given in a bar chart

- Turn the data from the bar chart into a **table**
- Then use the method for finding the median in the 'Averages from Tables' revision note

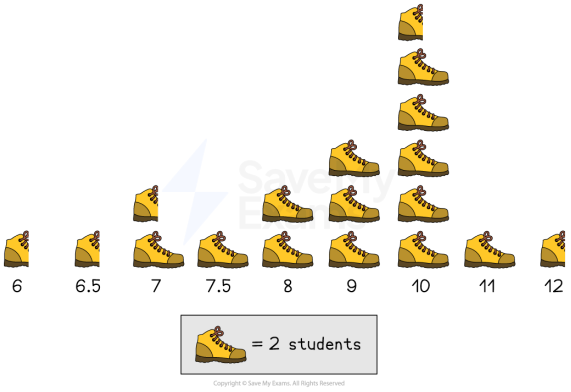
Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it



Example of a bar chart

What is a pictogram?

- A **pictogram** is an **alternative** to a bar chart
  - It is used in the same situations
- There are **no axes**
  - **Frequency** is represented by **symbols**
  - A **key** shows the value of 1 symbol
    - For example, 1 symbol represents a frequency of 2
  - Half and quarter symbols are often used



Example of a pictogram

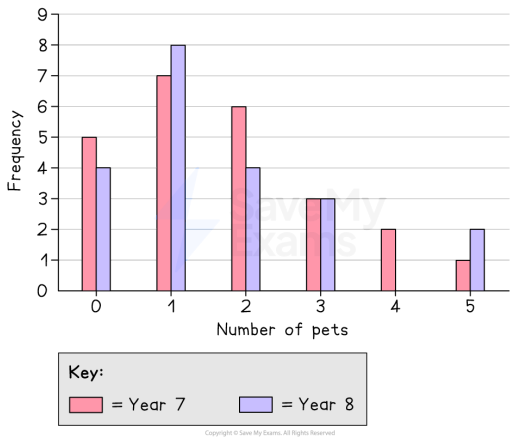
- The pictogram above shows the shoe sizes of students in a class
  - As 1 picture of a shoe represents 2 students
    - Half a shoe represents 1 student
  - The number of students with a shoe size of 7, is 3

Examiner Tips and Tricks

- If asked to draw a bar chart, find the largest frequency and choose a scale which makes that fit in the space

Worked Example

Mr Barr teaches students in Year 7 and Year 8.
He records the number of pets that students in each year have.
His results are shown below.



(a) Write down the modal number of pets for his Year 7 students.

Answer:

The modal number (mode) is the number of pets that occurs the most
Visually, this will be the highest bar for Year 7s

The mode for Year 7 is 1 pet

(b) How many Year 8 students does he teach?

Answer:

Add up all the heights (frequencies) of the Year 8 bars

$$4 + 8 + 4 + 3 + 0 + 2$$

He teaches 21 Year 8 students

Teacher only

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